Salesforce Day 4

Apex Development – Daily Task Documentation

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Topic: Your First Lightning Web Component (LWC)

Today's task focused on moving from the backend of the Placement Management System (data model, SOQL queries, Apex triggers, and automation) to building an actual user interface using Lightning Web Components. The goal was to understand how a Salesforce application flows from the database up to the screen, and to build the first working components of the Placement Portal.

Learning Objectives Covered

- Understood what Lightning Web Components (LWC) are and why Salesforce introduced them.
- Created a Lightning Web Component from scratch and deployed it to a Lightning Page.
- Understood the three-file structure of an LWC (HTML, JavaScript, meta XML).
- Used basic data binding to display dynamic values on screen.
- Handled button click events using JavaScript only, without Apex.
- Built the first screen of the Placement Management System with hard-coded data.

Work Completed

1. placementHome Component

Created the first LWC named **placementHome**, displaying the heading "Welcome to Vishnu Placement Portal" along with a short description and a "Get Started" button. This component was deployed onto a Lightning Page in the Placement app.

2. studentInfo Component

Built the **studentInfo** component to demonstrate data binding. It displays the Student Name, Roll Number, and Department using bound JavaScript variables, along with an "Update Student Info" button.

3. welcomeMessage Component

Created the **welcomeMessage** component containing a "Show Welcome Message" button. Clicking the button displays a welcome message on screen, handled entirely with JavaScript event handling — no Apex or database calls involved.

4. Job Application Status Toggle

Implemented a button-driven status display that initially shows "Status : Not Applied" and updates to "Status : Applied" when the Apply button is clicked, again using only client-side JavaScript.

5. Placement Dashboard (Mini Project Enhancement)

Assembled the first full screen of the Placement Management System, combining the Placement Portal banner, today's date, a welcome message for the student, and summary tiles for Number of Companies (25), Number of Jobs (63), and Applications Submitted (5), with "Browse Jobs" and "My Applications" actions. All values were hard-coded for this stage, to be connected to Apex in a later task.

Key Learnings

- LWC is Salesforce's modern UI framework built on native Web Standards (HTML, JavaScript, CSS), enabling reusable and fast interfaces.
- Every LWC is composed of three files: the HTML file for layout, the JavaScript file for logic and events, and the meta XML file that exposes the component to Lightning App Builder.
- Data binding using curly-brace syntax (e.g. {studentName}) automatically reflects JavaScript variable changes on the UI.
- Simple UI interactions, such as toggling a status or showing a message, can be handled entirely in JavaScript without touching Apex or the database.
- The overall architecture flows from the User through the Lightning Web Component, into Apex Classes, then SOQL, and finally the Salesforce Database.

Screenshots

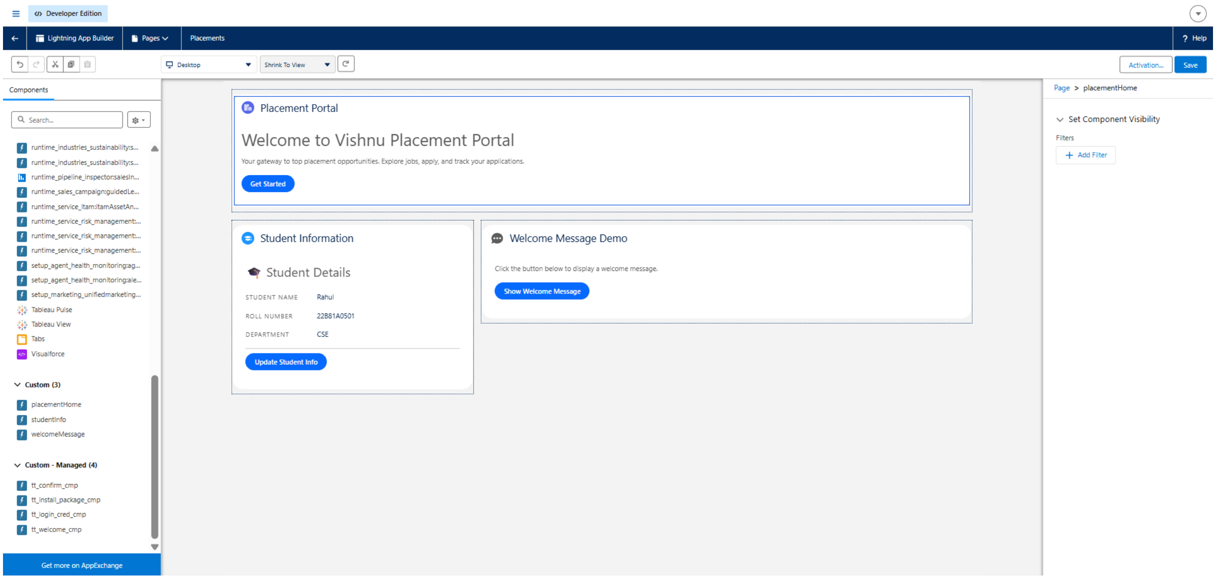

Fig 1: placementHome, studentInfo, and welcomeMessage components on the Lightning Page.

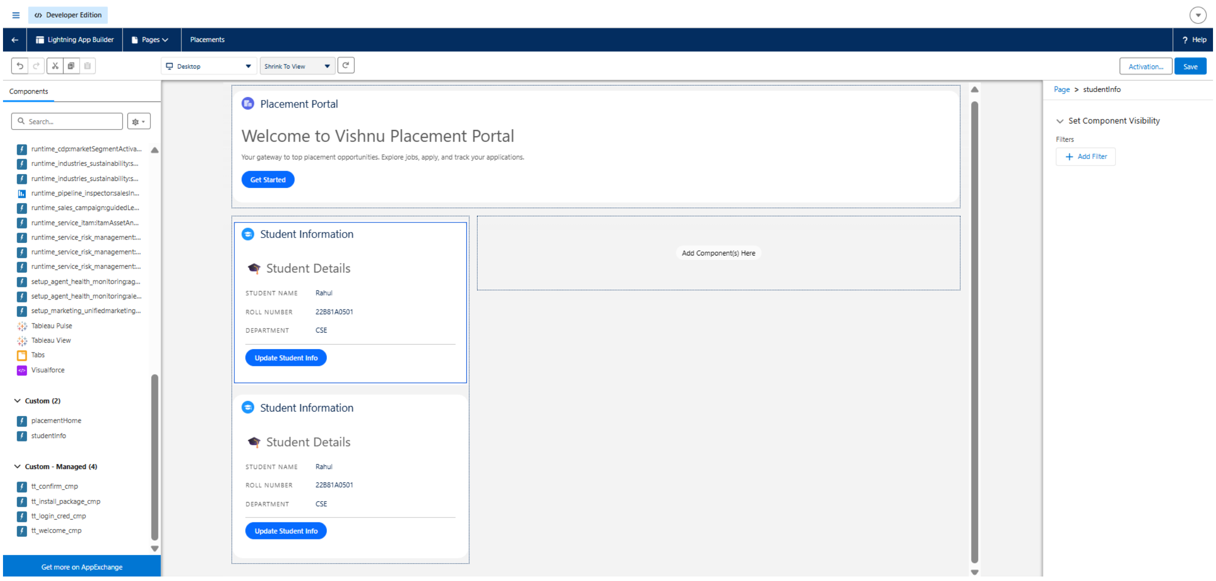

Fig 2: studentInfo component showing Student Details with data-bound fields.

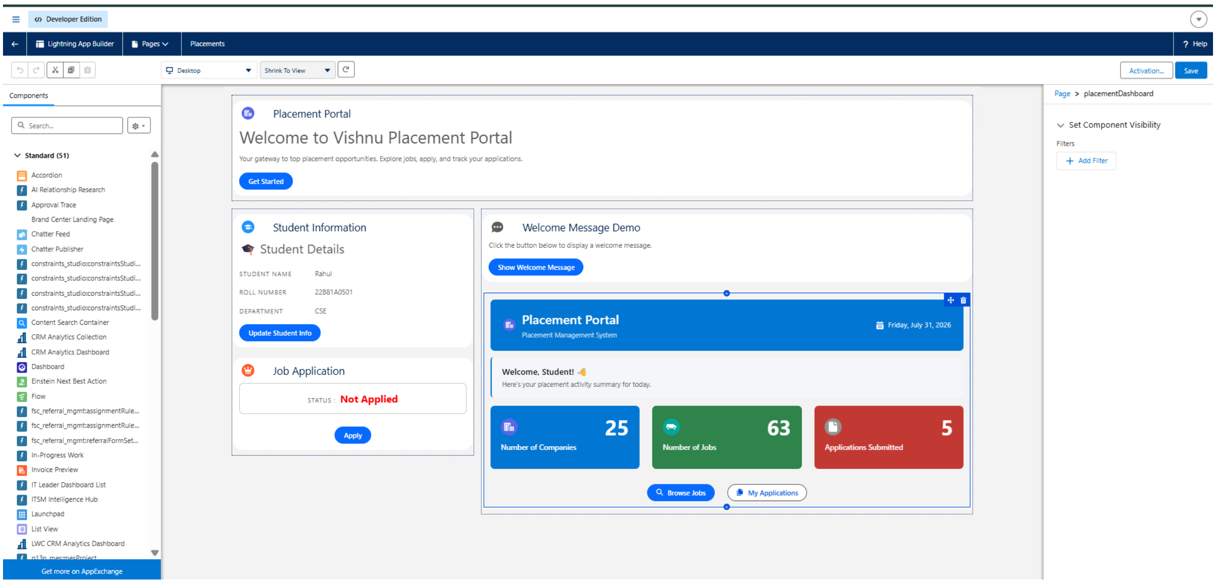

Fig 3: Placement Dashboard mini-project screen with summary tiles and actions.